



Morning Prayers in the Bach Family
(Painting by Rosenthal)

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Johann Sebastian Bach, the greatest of all the masters of music, came of a musical family whose ancestors for nearly 200 years had been noted among the townspeople of Eisenach, Germany. The story is told that his great-great-grandfather, a very jovial miller, used to sit in the door of his mill and sing and play his zither while the mill-wheel went 'round and 'round grinding the grain. At the age of ten, Johann's father died and he went to live with his brother, also a musician. As it was difficult to get music in those days, young Bach used to copy his brother's music by the moonlight. At the age of eighteen, he often walked for miles, sometimes without food, en route to Hamburg where he could listen to concerts. Toward the end of his life, Bach was a great favourite among the princes and kings. Nothing gave him as much pleasure as having his many children and relations assemble in the Bach home and play music.

Menuet

J. S. Bach (1685 - 1750)

Moderato

The Menuet is a very old dance of French origin. Its title is derived from the French word *menu* (small) and refers to the steps of the dance. It should be played at a rather deliberate tempo and as gracefully as possible. Be sure to observe all phrasing marks.